for American citizenship, in each case its marquee visitors testing its boundaries or modes of refuge on either side of the Wall.

In her own transnational account, Davis directly contends with the legacy of Kennedy's call of symbolic citizenship as an honorary "Berliner" during his visit to West Berlin in her autobiography. However, it is Robeson with whom her own life circumstances closely resonate, in and out of divided Berlin. In the United States, both withstood life-altering public rebuke and trials for their activism and turned to autobiographical writing to reclaim their own narratives. Both also spent time in East Germany, treating the country as a space of refuge. Beyond their personal protections, both received high honors from state officials. Their status as American Berliners anchored in the East differed from the status of Kennedy and other political and cultural visitors chiefly operating in West Berlin. Border crossings into East Berlin for figures like Davis and Robeson were marked by ease or fulfilment, rather than treated as flights into enemy territory either over, under, or through the Wall.

———

After returning from her trip to West and East Berlin, Davis finished another year of school in Frankfurt before moving back to America. She left West Germany in the spring of 1967, summoned by the burgeoning Black Power movement. On her way back to the United States, she stopped in London, where she attended the May conference on the "Dialectics of Liberation" with her mentor Herbert Marcuse and Trinidadian American organizer Stokely Carmichael. From there she went on to Southern California, briefly to Watts and then in the fall to San Diego, where she would continue her graduate work at the University of California, San Diego. In readjusting to life in the United States, Davis remarked on the changes in her own outlook after her years abroad and the ways in which the political climate had altered with new tensions. She encountered hostility when demonstrating against the Vietnam War and noticed intense police presence and repression encircling acts of public protest, especially around universities. Davis sensed a rise in the policing of dissidence and black liberation. She found solidarity through associations with several activist groups, including the Student Nonviolent Coordinating Committee, the Black Panther Party, the Communist Party, and the Che-Lumumba Club. In 1969 she accepted a position in the philosophy department at UCLA to teach a class on black literature as a way to support